**DRILL 01**

PPE & SCBA

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.1, 4.3.3) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

# SCBA DONNING, SEAL CHECK & EMERGENCY BYPASS

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Any Engine/Pumper | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & SCBA

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | Firefighter Pairs (Buddy System)

## 🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to don and seal their SCBA within **60 seconds**, perform operational safety checks, and operate the emergency bypass valve without looking. In rural NB, initial arriving crews (often 2–3 members) cannot afford fumbling with straps or discovering an empty cylinder or leaking facepiece seal at the front door.

## 📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- Apparatus SCBA packs and facepieces (minimum 1 per member; min 4,000 PSI cylinder pressure).
- Timing device / stopwatch (for Phase 3 only).
- Disinfectant wipes and clean towels for reset.
- Set up 2–4 donning mats or staging blankets on the apparatus bay floor.

## ⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191 Compliance:** Ensure no jewellery is worn. Flash hoods must be completely tucked under bunker coat collars with no skin exposed.

⚠️ **Pinch Points & Lifting:** Check for proper lifting mechanics when hoisting SCBA packs.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: If a member shows signs of hyperventilation, dizziness, or a strap snags dangerously, shout "STOP!" to pause the evolution.**

## PHASE 1: TAILGATE WALKTHROUGH (10 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. Drill Leader demonstrates the **Over-the-Head** and **Coat Method** donning techniques slowly.
2. Review the **Pre-Donning Check (COAT)**:
   - **C**ylinder: Full (min 4,000–4,500 PSI) and open fully.
   - **O**utlet/Regulator: Clean, HUD working, bypass valve closed (clockwise).
   - **A**ir/Harness: Straps fully extended, waist belt unbuckled.
   - **T**esting PASS: Manual alarm activation and auto-reset.
3. Review facepiece seal: Negative pressure test (cover regulator port with palm, inhale gently, hold 5 seconds; mask must collapse slightly with no inward air leaks).

# DRILL 01: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF

PPE & SCBA • Practical Application

## PHASE 2: SLOW REPETITION & COACHING (20 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. Firefighters pair up in buddies (Firefighter A and B).
2. Firefighter A dons gear step-by-step; Firefighter B acts as safety checker:
   - Don pants and boots.
   - Pull hood over head onto neck.
   - Don SCBA harness (tighten waist belt first to place weight on hips, then pull shoulder straps down).
   - Fasten chest strap (if equipped).
   - Don facepiece (chin in pocket, tighten lower straps then upper straps, never overtighten).
   - Conduct negative pressure seal check.
   - Pull flash hood up and over mask seal, covering all hair, ears, and neck.
   - Don helmet and fasten chinstrap snugly.
   - Don gloves. Click regulator into facepiece, take a deep breath to activate positive pressure.
   - Buddy B checks Buddy A for 100% skin coverage and strap security, then they swap.

## PHASE 3: REAL-TIME CHALLENGE (15 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. **The 60-Second Challenge:** Members start in bunker pants/boots with coat open. On the whistle, don SCBA, facepiece, hood, helmet, and gloves, and achieve positive pressure within 60 seconds.
2. **Blacked-Out Emergency Bypass Rep:** Firefighters close their eyes (or reverse their flash hood over their mask). On command, locate and open the red purge/bypass valve to deliver a continuous stream of air, then close it back to normal flow using gloved hands only.

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### ⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Waist belt left unbuckled or dangling:* Shifts all pack weight onto the shoulders, causing rapid fatigue.
- ❌ *Flash hood bunched over facepiece seal:* Breaks the airtight seal and causes catastrophic air leakage.
- ❌ *Over-tightening mask straps:* Distorts the silicone seal and causes leaks around temples.
- ❌ *Forgetting to open cylinder valve completely:* Can cause low-pressure starvation during heavy exertion.

### 🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Who struggled to don gloves with wet/cold hands?", "Did anyone feel air leaking around their temple or jawline?"***

### ✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ All SCBA cylinders refilled to 4,000–4,500 PSI or swapped with full bottles from the rack.
- ☐ Regulators disinfected and clipped into their protective holders.
- ☐ Facepieces wiped dry, inspected for scratches/tears, and placed in bags.
- ☐ All harness straps (shoulders, waist, chest) fully extended/loosened for the next call.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

| DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE | SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE | DATE COMPLETED | TRAINING HOURS |
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